

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1997-08-11

1 dear bahá'í friends,
2 in our letter of 10 october 1994 conveying a paper on the external affairs
3 to say that the coordination of the external affairs work would be effected through
close collaboration between National Spiritual Assemblies and the

bahá'í international community's united Nations office and office of

4 public information, and we also indicated that it would take some time
5 before these offices would be prepared to initiate communications with you
6 concerning the details of the plans to be pursued. our purpose in writing
7 to you now is to say that the united Nations office will shortly launch
8 its first coordinated program of diplomatic work in accordance with the
9 strategy. The program will be concerned with human rights education. in
10 anticipation of this initial effort, the house of justice wishes us to convey
11 the following.

12 As you know, the external affairs work falls into two main categories:

diplomatic and public information. The emphasis of the united Nations

13 office, as distinct from that of the office of public information, will be
14 on the plans to be executed by your Assemblies towards building effective relations
with your governments and influencing official attitudes and poli-cies on matters of global,
rather than of strictly national, importance. The
15 efforts thus required necessitate the exercise of skills and approaches similar
16 to those employed in the campaign to defend our persecuted coreligionists in iran
and other countries. The obvious difference with the external affairs
17 strategy is that your concentration will be on promoting the interests of society as a
whole and not on calling attention to a need to assist the bahá'í

community.252.3

253 1

253 2

254 1996–2000 • The four Year Plan

255 599important as is the external affairs work, occupation with it must not be
256 allowed to detract from the major aim of the four year plan: namely, to
257 advance the process of entry by troops. The house of justice has already
258 encouraged you to devise channels through which you may carry out this
259 work—either by the formation of committees, the setting up of offices, the
assignment of tasks to capable individuals, or some combination of
260 these. Since the activities involved are not of a kind that can be undertaken
261 by members of the community in general, but must be engaged in by a relatively few
individuals of the proper aptitude, stature and means, you can fulfill the diplomatic
requirements of the external affairs strategy without
262 diverting attention from the teaching work. Training will no doubt have
263 to be given to some of the individuals you appoint; this is a matter about which the u
nited Nations office will advise you as necessary.
264 A number of you have already made significant advances in this special
265 field, and the house of justice confidently and with great anticipation looks
266 forward to the progress to be attained as you enter into a new phase of collaboration
with the bahá'í international community's united Nations
267 office.
268 with loving bahá'í greetings,

for Department of the secretariat

269 254

Martyrdom of Two Believers in Iran

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]